

Westbrook University

Office of Academic Affairs

Policy No: ACAD-ATT-001

Effective: August 1, 2024

Revision: 1.0

Class Attendance Policy

1. Policy Statement

Westbrook University regards regular class attendance as essential to the educational experience. Students are expected to attend every scheduled class meeting. Consistent attendance is strongly correlated with academic success and professional readiness.

2. Attendance Requirements

Students are permitted a maximum of 3 unexcused absences per semester in any single course. Exceeding this threshold carries the following academic consequences:

- 4 unexcused absences: The instructor may reduce the final course grade by one full letter grade (e.g., B to C).
- 5 unexcused absences: The instructor may reduce the final grade by two full letter grades.
- 6 or more unexcused absences: The instructor may assign a grade of F for the course, regardless of other performance.

3. Recording Attendance

Instructors are required to record attendance for every class session using the university's Learning Management System (LMS). Attendance records are made available to students and academic advisors in real time. Students are responsible for monitoring their own attendance status.

4. Excused Absences

Absences may be excused under the conditions described in the Excused Absence Guidelines (ACAD-ATT-002). The burden of providing documentation rests with the student. Instructors are not required to excuse absences for which no documentation is provided within 72 hours of the absence.

5. Late Arrivals and Early Departures

Students who arrive more than 10 minutes late to class or who leave class before the session ends without prior instructor permission will be marked as tardy. Three tardies in a single course are equivalent to one unexcused absence. See Tardiness Policy (ACAD-ATT-004) for details.

6. Online and Hybrid Courses

For fully online courses, attendance is measured through participation in required activities such as discussion boards, quizzes, and synchronous session logins. A student who does not complete any required activity during a given week is considered absent for that week.

